



WhatsApp reached 400mn in India

WhatsApp has reached 400 million users in India, which is, by far, its biggest market. <https://dgit.in/aug19-81>



Google doin' good deeds

Google is giving away 1,00,00 Google Home mini smart speakers to paralysed people. <https://dgit.in/aug19-82>



Boardening one's horizons

Upgrading to the latest from AMD requires a bit more thought than your usual PC building regimen

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hen AMD announced their latest lineup of processors i.e. the 3rd Gen Ryzen processors, I got quite a few calls

from friends asking if this was it. Did AMD finally have a processor capable of beating Intel in all aspects? I'd say they have done a damn fine job of evening the scales. There are quite a few benchmarks in which Intel's 9th Gen processors are still ahead, however most of them are related to gaming. However, the performance gap has reduced to such an extent that it really doesn't matter which processor you go for. Here in India, you get the Intel Core i9-9900K and the AMD Ryzen 9 3900X for about the same price. AMD has more cores with each one being just about as performant as Intel's cores. So for someone wanting more value out of their purchase, these new AMD processors have just as much to offer as the top ones from Intel do. Up until now, building an AMD configuration was relatively cheaper than building an Intel one. However, that changed with the new generation of AMD Ryzen processors because of the new X570 chipset motherboards which are in league with Intel's Z-series boards from a cost perspective.

Fundamentally, X570 differs from X470 by means of incorporating PCIe 4.0. The PCH can now talk to peripherals via PCIe 4.0 so that's a benefit for

hardware starved of bandwidth. In the consumer space, this amounts to barely anything. SSDs are the only thing that properly benefit from the introduction of PCIe 4.0, however, the performance increment is something that ordinary consumers will not be able to differentiate. Existing NVMe PCIe SSDs can easily hit 3,500 MBps so what difference does an additional 1500 MBps bring to the table? For folks involved in Data Science, a lot. And for folks who aren't, nothing. Throwing in a ridiculous amount of cores onto a processor also increases power consumption. If you're going at this the Intel way, then you would see a new chipset accompanied by a new socket. Which was and continues to be one of the primary reasons why Intel configurations are more expensive to build. When you look at AMD, however, the same AM4 socket is being followed and all motherboards are compatible with future AMD AM4 processors. The problem here is that newer CPUs need more beefier VRM circuits or else you'll end up with a fried motherboard. When your socket can support everything from the lowest 4-core Ryzen 3 to the top-of-the-line Ryzen 9, you have to perform your due diligence before putting a rig together. Especially, if you're going to be over-

clocking in the future. Then you have to account for more Vcore headroom.

So, the good folks over at Reddit (led by u/Cr1318) have put together an excellent list of all past and current AMD motherboards except the low-end A320 boards along with the max Vcore rating for buyers to refer to before figuring out which motherboard to go for or if their current AMD motherboard can support the newer Ryzen 3rd Gen processors with ease. And also if the board can handle an aggressive overclock. You can find the list here - <https://dgit.in/32PXFxr>. Just see if

your board is marked green for the processor that you want to combine it with.

This brings into perspective, the advantages and disadvantages of the product strategies followed by Intel and AMD. One adds value which helps consumers upgrade over time and not have to swap out their entire configuration for a performance boost. The other strategy is more about idiot-proofing and makes it difficult for users to mess up. It can be argued that cost cutting measures taken by board manufacturers might negate the idiot-proofing steps taken by the processor manufacturers but that's applicable to both, Intel and AMD here. We hear Intel's answer to AMD's 3rd Gen processors is right around the corner. It'll be fun to see how this pans out.

